7. To call for special studies or investigations into specific problems or situations arising out of discrimination and atrocities against women and to identify the constraints so as to recommend strategies for their removal

8. To undertake promotional and educational research so as to suggest ways of ensuring due representation of women in all spheres and to identify factors responsible for impeding their advancement, such as, lack of access to housing and basic services, inadequate support services and technologies for reducing drudgery and occupational health hazards and for increasing their productivity

9. To participate and advice on the planning process of socio-economic development of women

10. To evaluate the progress of the development of women under the Union and any state

11. To inspect any jail, remand home, women's institution or other place of custody where women are kept as prisoners or otherwise, and take up with the concerned authorities for remedial action

12. To fund litigation involving issues affecting a large body of women

13. To make periodical reports to the government on any matter pertaining to women and in particular various difficulties under which women toil

14. To look into any other matter referred to it by the Central Government

The Commission presents an annual report to the Central Government. It can also submit a report as and when it thinks necessary.

The Central Government places all such reports before each House of Parliament, along with a memorandum explaining the action taken on the recommendations made by the Commission. The memorandum should also contain the reasons for the non-acceptance of any of such recommendations.

If any such report is related to any matter with which any State Government is concerned, the Commission forwards a copy of such report to such State Government. The State Government places it before the state legislature, along with a memorandum explaining the action taken on the recommendations of the commission. The memorandum should also contain the reasons for the non-acceptance of any of such recommendations.

Powers

The Commission can appoint the committees necessary for dealing with the special issues taken up by it from time to time. It is also empowered to co-opt as members of any such committee the persons from outside the Commission (i.e. those who are not members of the Commission). The co-opted persons can attend the meetings of the committee and take part in its proceedings but without the right to vote.

The Commission shall regulate its own procedure and also the procedure of its committees.

The Commission, while investigating any matter or inquiring into any complaint, has all the powers of a civil court trying a suit and in particular in respect of the following matters: